



ACCOUNTANT

JOB DESCRIPTION

Accountants play a vital role in the operation of virtually every business and organization, ensuring that financial systems run smoothly and that tax laws and other regulations are followed. They calculate annual accounts and produce financial reports, and may specialize in other areas, such as fraud detection. Senior accountants may play a strategic role, advising the leaders of a business or organization.



SALARY

Associate ★★★★★

Senior partner ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Consistent demand for industry professionals • Highest salaries in banking and finance accountancy • Fierce competition for positions in large firms

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Finance • Accounting • Economics • Mathematics • Statistics • Information Technology (IT) • Business studies



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS Applicants can join accounting firms as assistants and learn on the job, or as associates after completing their bachelor's degree.



LIFESTYLE Regular office hours are the norm, although some overtime may be required to complete reports or financial audits to tight schedules.



LOCATION The work is largely office-based. Travel to meet clients and conduct audits—an official examination of accounts—is a vital part of the job.



THE REALITIES Although the financial rewards can be high, evening and weekend work is often required to meet deadlines during busy periods.

CAREER PATHS

There are two main types of accounting: public practice, in which accounting services are provided to clients, and management accounting, in which accountants work in-house for a public- or private-sector organization or business. Career progression may follow a structured path, from accreditation, to gaining experience in different sectors—such as tax or corporate finance—leading to promotion to management, and eventually, partnership in a firm.

INTERN You may be taken on as an accounting intern by a company while you are studying for your accounting degree. This experience may help you find full-time employment as an accountant after college.



GRADUATE With a degree in accounting or a related discipline, you can apply for entry-level positions, which are offered by many large accountancy firms, public-sector organizations, and commercial businesses in all sectors of industry.

